

13.1 Introduction

Study staff should be particularly alert to complaints or concerns from participants (Cases and Controls), as some may not clearly communicate the extent of their discomfort or concern. Interviewers and phlebotomists should refer all participant complaints and potential problems to the Study Manager.

Participants who report feeling ill or who appear ill should be reported to the Study Manager or Assistant Study Manager. Some participants may have had prior problems related to the procedure being performed. At times, participants may have nonspecific complaints such as viral illnesses, pain, or fatigue. Study staff should offer to have the Study Manager or the Assistant Study Manager speak with the participant who has a particular complaint. If a participant agrees to the procedure but appears to not feel well, the study staff should offer to conduct the procedure at another time or offer to have the Study Manager speak to the participant. If the participant is reluctant or refuses, and there is any question about the health or safety of the participant, study staff should consult the Study Manager for recommendations on how to proceed.

This section describes some possible adverse events that require reporting to the lead study staff and Principal Investigator(s) and, ultimately, to NCI and Westat. There are other situations that may require the attention of the lead study staff that are not included as a reportable adverse event. Study staff are expected to follow these guidelines and use their best judgment when deciding whether or not to bring a participant's complaint or problem to the attention of the lead study staff. As a rule, any doubts about the status of a participant should be communicated to the lead study staff.

13.2 Monitoring Adverse Events

Study staff are responsible for monitoring the occurrence of adverse events among participants (Cases and Controls), which may be related to their participation in the study. Adverse events, which occur while the participant is physically at the hospital during the interview, anthropometry

measurements, saliva collection, and blood collection procedures, should be documented on the Adverse Events Form (AEF). (See Appendix 13-1 for the Adverse Events Form).

Adverse events will be reported to Westat and NCI through the completion of the AEF. The Study Manager will report adverse events to Westat within 48 hours of the occurrence of the adverse event. Adverse events are defined as fitting into one or more of the following categories:

- Fainting;
- Light Headedness;
- Nausea;
- Fall; and
- Other (Specify).

When an adverse event occurs during the anthropometry measurements or the saliva collection, the Interviewer must report the event immediately to the Study Manager or the Assistant Study Manager. Adverse events that occur during the blood collection procedure must be reported immediately by the hospital phlebotomist to the Study Manager. The Study Manager or the Assistant Study Manager are responsible for completing the AEF in the presence of the Interviewer or the phlebotomist. The Study Manager is also responsible for notifying the study Principal Investigator(s) of the adverse event and obtaining the Principal Investigator's initials on the AEF.

13.3 Completion of Adverse Events Form

The Study Manager and Assistant Study Manager are responsible for completion of the AEF. Please refer to Appendix 13-2 for specifications on completion of the AEF.

13.4 Reporting Adverse Events to Westat

Reporting of adverse events will be documented on the AEF and transmitted to Westat within 48 hours. The Study Manager should fax a copy of the AEF to Michelle Brotzman, Project Director, at 301/294-2065. The form is designed to collect the appropriate information for review by NCI and Westat. NCI will review all the events and determine which, if any, require notification to the IRB.

The Study Manager should maintain a record of all adverse events that occur. Copies of the AEFs should be filed in the study office.